

1. Moby-Dick — A2

1.1 Baseline

That morning I looked around Nantucket for a good whaling ship. I stopped looking when I saw the Pequod. It was tall and strong. Its wood was dark from many years on the wild oceans.

I went onto the ship. A man sat at a table with a big book in front of him. He wore a long black coat and a big black hat. He didn't smile.

"This is a fine ship and I want to go whaling with you! Where do I write my name, Captain?" I asked happily.

"I'm not the captain. Captain Ahab is sick. He's down below. I'm Starbuck. Are you a whaler?" he asked.

"No, but I'm a good sailor," I answered. "You can ask the captains of my other ships."

"I'm not interested in your captains and your ships," he said. "Sailing is not whaling. Whaling is a hard life. You'll be away from home for many years. The work is difficult. You have to be strong and fast. And it's very dangerous."

"I want to learn. And I want to see the world," I said.

"Oh, you'll see the world. And you'll see more—good and bad. Some very bad things."

He looked at me for a minute. Then he spoke again. "I'll tell you about whaling. Captain Ahab has only one leg. And do you know why? Because a whale took his other leg. A huge whale took it off!"

I said nothing. What could I say?

"So, you want to be a whaler on Captain Ahab's ship. Can you look into the eye of a whale? Can you stand in front of its huge mouth and throw your harpoon?"

"I can and I will!" I shouted. "I'm not afraid. I'm a good sailor. You'll see! This is my life and I..."

He stopped me and turned the big book around. "Write your name here," he said.

His eyes were tired.

"Thank you. You won't be sorry," I said.

"Don't forget my words," he answered.

"I have a friend. He's a good whaler," I said.

"We'll see. Bring him tomorrow," said Starbuck.

Queequeg and I went to the Pequod the next day. The men on the ship laughed at this huge, ugly man. Queequeg didn't say anything. He looked down at the water from the ship. Then he turned and spoke to the men.

"Do you see that bird?" he asked.

The men looked, but they couldn't see anything.

"There," said Queequeg.

The men looked carefully this time and saw a small dead bird a long way away on the water.

"That bird is a whale's eye," said Queequeg. He threw his harpoon and hit the bird. "Now that whale is dead," he said.

The men were quiet. Queequeg was better than every other man on that ship. And so the Pequod had two new whalers.

We went to our room and got our things. An old man stopped us on the street before we got back to the Pequod.

"Are you sailing with Captain Ahab? Do you know him?" he asked.

"Yes. We're sailing with him. He's sick now. But we'll meet him later," I answered.

"Sick!" he shouted. "Yes! He's a sick man. He's the DEVIL!"

"And who are you?" I asked.

"I'm Elijah," he answered.

"Why do you say this about Captain Ahab? Men say that he's a good whaler. He knows the ocean."

"They're right," answered the man quietly. Then his eyes turned big and wild. "But he's the DEVIL! I sailed with him. I know! And his men are the Devil's helpers!" He looked at me strangely. "He only has one leg. Do you know Captain Ahab's story?"

I suddenly felt afraid. "Of course we do," I said. I turned to Queequeg. "Come, my friend," I said. "Let's leave this crazy old man." And we went quickly to the ship.

1.2 Enriched

I was looking around Nantucket for a good whaling ship that morning. I stopped looking when I saw the Pequod. It was tall and strong. It was a dark wood, aged from many years on the wild oceans.

I went aboard the ship. A man was sitting at a table with a big book in front of him. He was wearing a long black coat and a huge black hat. He didn't smile.

“This is a fine ship and I want to go whaling with you! Where do I write my name, Captain?” I asked happily.

“I’m not the captain. Captain Ahab is sick. He’s down below. I’m Starbuck. Are you a whaler?” he asked.

“No, but I’m a good sailor,” I answered. “You can ask the captains of my other ships.”

“I’m not interested in your captains and your ships,” he said. “Sailing is not whaling. Whaling is a very hard life. You’ll be away from home for many years. The work is very difficult. You have to be strong and fast. And it’s very dangerous.”

“I want to learn. And I want to see the world,” I said.

“Oh, you’ll see the world. And you’ll see more—good and bad. Some very bad things.”

He looked at me for a minute. And then he spoke again.

“I’ll tell you about whaling. Captain Ahab has only one leg. And do you know why? Because a whale took his other leg. A huge whale took it off!”

I said nothing. What could I say?

“So, you want to be a whaler on Captain Ahab’s ship. Can you look into the eye of a whale? Can you stand in front of its huge mouth and throw your harpoon?”

“I can and I will!” I shouted. “I’m not afraid. I’m a good sailor. You’ll see! This is my life and I...”

He stopped me and turned the big book around.

“Write your name here,” he said.

His eyes were exhausted.

“Thank you. You won’t be sorry,” I said.

“Don’t forget my words,” he answered.

“I have a friend. He’s a good whaler,” I said.

“We’ll see. Bring him tomorrow,” said Starbuck.

Queequeg and I went to the Pequod the next day. The men on the ship laughed at this huge, ugly man with his tattoos. Queequeg didn’t say anything. He looked down at the water from the ship. And then he turned to the men and spoke to them.

“Do you see that bird?” he asked.

The men looked, but they couldn’t see anything.

“There,” said Queequeg.

The men looked carefully at the dead bird and then saw it was on the water far away.

“That bird is a whale’s eye,” said Queequeg. He threw his harpoon at the bird, then hit it.

“Now that whale is dead,” he said.

The men were quiet. Queequeg was better than every other man on that ship. And the Pequod now had two new whalers.

We went to our room and got our things. An old man stopped us on the street before we reached the Pequod.

“Are you sailing with Captain Ahab?” he said. “Do you know him?”

“Yes. We’re sailing with him. He’s sick now. But we’ll meet him later,” I answered.

“Sick!” he shouted. “Yes! He’s a sick man. He’s the DEVIL!”

“And who are you?” I asked.

“I’m Elijah,” he answered.

“Why do you say this about Captain Ahab? Men say that he’s a good whaler. He knows the ocean.”

“They’re right,” answered the man quietly. His eyes got big and wild, too. “But he’s the DEVIL! I sailed with him. I know! And his men are the Devil’s helpers!”

He stared at me curiously.

“He only has one leg. Do you know Captain Ahab’s story?”

I was suddenly terrified.

“Of course we do,” I said.

I turned to Queequeg.

“Come, my friend,” I said. “Let’s leave this crazy old man.”

And we quickly got to the ship.

1.3 Style transfer

That morning I looked around Nantucket for a good whaling ship. I stopped looking when I saw the Pequod – a tall and strong ship. Its wood was dark from many years on the wild oceans.

I went onto the ship. A man sat at a table with a big book in front of him. He wore a long black coat and a big black hat. He didn’t smile.

“This is a fine ship and I want to go whaling with you! Where do I write my name, Captain?” I asked happily.

“I’m not the captain. Captain Ahab is sick. He’s down below. I’m Starbuck. Are you a whaler?” he asked.

“No, but I’m a good sailor, sir” I answered. “You can ask the captains of my previous ships.”

“I’m not interested in your captains and your ships,” he said. “Sailing is not whaling. Whaling is a hard life. You’ll be away from home for many long years. The work is difficult. You have to be strong and fast. And it’s a very dangerous job.”

“I want to learn. And I want to see the big world.” I said.

“Oh, you’ll see the world. And you’ll see more—good and bad. Some very bad things.”

He looked at me for a short moment. Then he spoke again.

“I’ll tell you about whaling. Captain Ahab has only one leg. And do you know why? Because his other one was taken by a whale! A huge whale took it off!”

I said nothing. What could I say?

" So, you want to be a whaler on Captain Ahab’s ship. I say, did you ever stand in the head of a whale-boat? Can you look into the eye of a whale? Can you stand in front of its huge jaw and throw your harpoon?"

"Aye, I can and I will!" I shouted. "I’m not afraid. I’m a good sailor. You’ll see! This is my life and I ..."

He stopped me and turned the big book around.

“Write your name here.” he said.

His eyes were tired.

“Thank you. You won’t be sorry,” I said.

“Don’t forget my words,” he answered.

“I have a mate. He’s a good whaler,” I said.

“We’ll see. Bring him tomorrow,” said Starbuck.

Queequeg and I went to the Pequod the next day. The men on the ship laughed at this huge, ugly man. Queequeg didn’t say anything. He looked down at the water from the ship. Then he turned and spoke to the men.

“Do you see that bird?” he asked.

The men looked, but they couldn’t see anything.

"There," said Queequeg.

The men looked carefully this time and saw a small dead bird a long way away on the water.

"That bird is a whale's eye," said Queequeg.

He threw his harpoon and hit the bird.

"Now that whale is dead," he said.

The men were quiet. Queequeg was better than every other man on that ship. And so the Pequod had two new whalers.

We went to our room and got our things. An old man stopped us on the street before we got back to the Pequod.

"Are you sailing with Captain Ahab? Do you know him?" he asked.

"Yes. We're sailing with him. He's sick now. But we'll meet him later" I answered.

"Sick!" he shouted. "Yes! He's a sick man. He's the DEVIL!"

"And who are you?" I asked.

"I'm Elijah," he answered.

"Why do you say this about Captain Ahab? Men say that he's a good whaler. He knows the ocean."

"They're right," answered the man quietly.

Then his eyes turned big and wild.

"But he's the DEVIL! I sailed with him. I know! And his men are the Devil's helpers!"

He looked at me strangely.

"He only has one leg. Do you know Captain Ahab's story?"

I suddenly felt afraid.

"Of course we do," I said.

I turned to Queequeg.

"Come my friend," I said. "Let's leave this crazy old man."

And we went quickly to the ship. Then it seemed to me that Elijah was following us, but with what intent I could not for the life of me imagine.

2. Moby-Dick — B2

2.1 Baseline

He started to get undressed and I saw that his whole body was covered with the same dark, square tattoos as his face. Then I saw him go to his jacket, which he had hung over a chair, and pull a little statue of a person and a piece of ship's biscuit out of a pocket. He put the statue in the fireplace and laid the biscuit in front of it, making strange noises. It seemed as if the statue was a god and he was praying to it. I was feeling more and more uncomfortable. Then the stranger took a tomahawk pipe from his bag, lit it from the lamp, and started to smoke. The next moment, he put out the lamp, and this cannibal, with his tomahawk pipe between his teeth, jumped into bed with me. I could not help it and shouted out.

"Stay where you are, keep quiet, and let me get up and light the lamp again."

But I quickly realized from his replies that he did not understand me.

"Who—you?" he said. "You not speak me. I kill you." And the lighted pipe began moving wildly around in the dark. "Tell me who you be," he said.

"Landlord! Peter Coffin!" I shouted. "Landlord! Save me!"

Hot tobacco ash was falling all around me, so I thought that soon the bed would be on fire. But then the landlord came into the room with a candle in his hand. Jumping from the bed, I ran to him.

"Don't be afraid now," said he, smiling at me with great amusement. "Queequeg would never hurt anyone."

"Stop laughing at me," I shouted. "Why didn't you tell me that the harpooneer was a cannibal?"

Peter Coffin was still smiling. "I thought you would understand when I told you he was selling New Zealand heads around the town. Now, go to sleep, both of you. Queequeg, this man is going to sleep here. Do you understand?"

Queequeg was still sitting in the bed and smoking his pipe. "You get in," he said to me, using his tomahawk pipe to point to the other side of the bed. He did this politely, and I looked at him closely. He was actually a handsome man, with a friendly-looking face.

"Why was I scared?" I thought. "This man is a human being, just like me."

I spoke to the landlord again. "Please, ask him to stop smoking, and I will get into bed. It's dangerous to smoke in bed!"

Peter Coffin explained this to Queequeg, who at once put down the tomahawk pipe. Again, he pointed politely to the other side of the bed, moving away from it to give me more space.

"Good night, Landlord," I said. "You may go."

I got into bed and quickly fell asleep. I never slept better in my life.

When I first woke up in the morning, I found Queequeg's arm thrown across me in a friendly way. You might have thought that I was his wife! For a while I lay there wide awake, but I must have fallen asleep again, because when I next woke up, Queequeg was standing next to the bed holding his harpoon. He pulled the pointed metal end from its wooden handle, then went across the room and, looking in the small piece of mirror, shaved, or rather "harpooned", his cheeks.

I quickly got up too and shaved—but not with a harpoon! Then we both went downstairs for breakfast. The bar was now full of sailors, nearly all whalemens with brown faces and thick beards, all wearing thick jackets because it was so cold.

"Here's breakfast!" cried the landlord, opening a door into the other room.

Breakfast was a strange meal. I was expecting to hear lots of talking and many stories of the sea, but all the men were quiet, as if they were not comfortable sitting round a table together.

2.2 Enriched

I saw his whole body covered in the same dark, square tattoos that he had on his face when he started to get undressed. Then I saw him go to his jacket, which he had hung over a chair, and pull a little statue of a person and a piece of ship's biscuit out of a pocket. He put the statue in the fireplace, and then laid the biscuit in front of the statue, making strange noises. It seemed as if the statue was a god and that he was praying to it. I felt more and more uncomfortable.

The stranger then took a tomahawk pipe from his bag, lit it from the lamp, and started to smoke. The next moment, he put out the lamp, and the cannibal jumped into bed with me (with his tomahawk pipe between his teeth, I think). I could not help but shout out.

"Stay where you are, keep quiet, and let me get up and light the lamp again."

But I quickly realized from his replies that he did not understand me.

"Who—you?" he said. "You not speak me. I kill you."

And the lighted pipe began moving wildly around in the dark.

"Tell me who you be," he said.

"Landlord! Peter Coffin!" I shouted. "Landlord! Save me!"

I thought that the bed would be on fire, since there was hot tobacco ash falling all around me. And then the landlord came into the room with a candle in his hand. I ran to him, after jumping from the bed.

"Don't be afraid now," he said, smiling at me with great amusement. "Queequeg would never hurt anyone."

"Stop laughing at me," I shouted. "Why didn't you tell me that the harpooneer was a cannibal?"

Peter Coffin was still smiling.

“I thought you would understand when I told you he was selling New Zealand heads around the town. Go to sleep, both of you, now. Queequeg, this man is going to sleep here. Do you understand?”

Queequeg was still sitting in the bed, smoking his pipe.

“You get in,” he said to me, using his tomahawk pipe to point to the other side of the bed.

He did this very politely, and I looked at him closely. He was actually a handsome, friendly-looking man, with a very pleasant face.

“Why was I scared?” I thought. “This man is a human being, just like me.”

I spoke to the landlord again.

“Please, ask him to stop smoking, and I will get into bed. It’s dangerous to smoke in bed!”

Peter Coffin explained it to Queequeg, who at once put down the tomahawk pipe. He then pointed to the other side of the bed, moving away from it, giving me more space.

“Good night, Landlord,” I said. “You may go.”

I got into bed and quickly fell asleep. I never slept better in my life.

When I first woke up in the morning, I found Queequeg’s arm thrown across me in a friendly way. You might have thought that I was his wife! I lay there wide awake for a while, but I must have fallen asleep again, because when I woke up, Queequeg was standing next to the bed with his harpoon. He pulled the pointed metal end from its wooden handle, then went across the room and, looking in the small piece of mirror, shaved, or rather “harpooned”, his cheeks.

I got up and shaved, too! But I shaved without using a harpoon! And we both went downstairs for breakfast. The bar was full of sailors, most with brown faces and thick beards, all wearing thick jackets because it was so cold.

“Here’s breakfast!” cried the landlord, opening a door into the other room.

Breakfast was a strange one. I expected to hear a lot of talking and stories about the sea, but all the men were quiet, as if they were not comfortable sitting around a table together.

2.3 Style transfer

He started to get undressed and I saw that his whole body was covered with the same dark, square tattoos as his face. Then I saw him go to his jacket, which he had hung over a chair, and pull a little statue of a person and a piece of ship’s biscuit out of a pocket.

He put that statue in the fireplace, and laid the biscuit in front of it, making strange noises. It seemed as if the statue was a god and he was praying to it. I was feeling more and more uncomfortable.

Then the stranger took a tomahawk pipe from his bag, lit it from the lamp, and started to smoke. The next moment, the lamp was put down by this cannibal and he, with his tomahawk pipe between his teeth, jumped into bed with me.

I could not help it and shouted out.

“Stay where you are, keep quiet, and let me get up and light the lamp again.”

But I quickly realized from his replies that he did not understand me.

“Who — you?” he said. “You not speak me. I kill you.”

And the lighted pipe began moving wildly around in the dark.

“Tell me who you be,” he said.

“Landlord! Peter Coffin!” I shouted. “Sir! Save me!”

Hot tobacco ash was falling all around me, so I thought that soon the bed would be on fire. Even as it was, I thought something of slipping out of the window, but it was the second floor back.

But then the landlord came into the room with a candle in his hand. Jumping from the bed, I ran to him.

“Don’t be afraid now,” said he, smiling at me with great amusement. “Queequeg would never hurt anyone.”

“Stop laughing at me,” I shouted. “Why didn’t you tell me that the whale hunter was a cannibal?”

Peter Coffin was still smiling.

“I thought you would understand when I told you he was selling New Zealand heads around this town. Now, go to sleep, both of you. Queequeg, this man is going to sleep here. Do you understand?”

Queequeg was still sitting in the bed and smoking his pipe.

“You get in,” he said to me, using his tomahawk pipe to point to the other side of the bed.

He did this politely, and I looked at him closely. He was actually a handsome man, with a friendly-looking face.

“Why was I scared?” I thought. “This man is a human being, just like me.”

I spoke to the landlord again.

“Please, ask him to stop smoking, and I will get into bed. It’s dangerous to smoke in that bed!”

Peter Coffin explained this to Queequeg, who at once put down the tomahawk pipe. Again, he pointed politely to the other side of the bed, moving away from it to give me more space.

“Good night, Landlord,” I said, “you may go.”

I got into bed, and quickly fell asleep. I never slept better in my life.

When I first woke up in the morning, I found Queequeg’s arm thrown across me in a friendly way. You might have thought that I was his wife! And it was so light too; the sun shining in at the window, and a great rattling of coaches in the streets, and the sound of gay voices all over the house.

For a while I lay there wide awake, but I must have fallen asleep again, because when I next woke up, Queequeg was standing next to the bed holding his harpoon.

He pulled that pointed metal end from its wooden handle, then went across the room and, looking in the small piece of mirror, shaved, or rather “harpooned”, his cheeks. Afterwards I wondered the less at this operation when I came to know of what fine steel the head of a harpoon is made, and how exceedingly sharp the long straight edges are always kept.

I quickly got up too and shaved (but not with a harpoon!), then we both went downstairs for breakfast. The bar was now full of sailors, nearly all whale hunters with brown faces and thick beards, all wearing thick jackets because it was so cold.

“Here’s breakfast!” cried the landlord, opening a door into the other room.

Breakfast was a strange meal. I was expecting to hear lots of talking and many stories of the sea, but all the men were quiet, as if they were not comfortable sitting round a table together.

3. The Picture of Dorian Gray — B1

3.1 Baseline

There was a crowd in the dull little theatre that evening. The three men went to their seats and waited for the play to begin. A quarter of an hour later, Sibyl Vane stepped onto the stage and she was one of the most beautiful girls Lord Henry had ever seen. In the crowd of scruffy actors, Sibyl Vane moved like a creature from a finer world. But she was strangely without life. She showed no sign of joy when she saw Romeo. Her voice was beautiful, but it was false. It was the wrong colour. It made the passion unreal. Dorian Gray became pale as he watched her. He was confused and worried, and his friends didn’t have the courage to say anything to him. They were horribly disappointed. She looked beautiful as she came out onto the stage, but her acting was terrible. She was a complete disaster.

When the second act was over, the audience started to hiss. Lord Henry stood up and put on his coat.

“She is very beautiful, Dorian, but she can’t act. Let’s go.”

“I’m sorry I’ve ruined your evening,” said Dorian Gray sadly. “I will stay and watch the rest of the play.”

“No, it’s not good for you to stay here and see bad acting. Come to the club with Basil and me.”

“Go away. I want to be alone. Can’t you see that my heart is breaking?” cried Dorian.

His two friends left him and the play continued. By the end, there was almost nobody left in the theatre.

As soon as it was over, Dorian ran to the dressing room and saw Sibyl with a look of triumph on her face, with a fire in her eyes. When she saw him, an expression of intense joy came over her.

“I acted so badly tonight!” she said.

“Yes, it was horrible. You have no idea how much I suffered. Are you ill?”

“I thought you would understand. You understand now, don’t you?”

“Understand what?” he asked angrily.

“Why I acted so badly. Why I will never act well again.” She was completely changed by joy and happiness. “Before I met you, acting was the only real thing in my life. I only knew the shadows of the stage and I thought they were real. But then you came, my beautiful love. You taught me what was real and freed me from my prison. Tonight, the words I spoke were not real; they were not my words. I could never act at being in love, because now I know what love really is.”

He threw himself down on the sofa and turned his face away.

“You have killed my love,” he whispered angrily. “You used to move my imagination. Now you don’t even move my curiosity. I loved you because you had genius and intellect. You gave shape to the dreams of poets. But now I see you are superficial and stupid. My God, what an idiot I was to love you! You are nothing to me now. I will never see you again. I will never mention your name.”

She threw herself at his feet and lay there like a crushed flower.

“Dorian, Dorian, don’t leave me!” she whispered. “I’m sorry I acted badly.”

3.2 Enriched

Please read the following text and answer the questions.

The dull little theatre was crowded that night. The three men went to their seats and waited for the play to begin. Sibyl Vane came on stage about half an hour later, and she was one of the most beautiful girls Lord Henry had ever seen. In the crowd of scruffy actors, Sibyl Vane moved like a creature from a finer world. But she was strangely without life. She showed no sign of joy when she saw Romeo. Her voice was beautiful, but it was false. It was the wrong color. It made the passion unreal.

Dorian Gray paled as he watched her. He was confused and worried, and his friends didn’t have the courage to say anything to him. They were utterly disappointed. She looked beautiful as she came onto the stage, but her acting was terrible. She was a total disaster.

The audience started to hiss when the second act ended. Lord Henry stood up and put on his coat.

“She is very beautiful, Dorian, but she can’t act. Let’s go.”

“I’m sorry I’ve ruined your evening,” said Dorian Gray sadly. “I will stay and watch the rest of the play.”

“No, it’s not good for you to stay here and see bad acting. Come to the club with Basil and me.”

“Go away. I want to be alone. Can’t you see that my heart is breaking?” cried Dorian.

His two friends left him and the play continued. By the end, there was almost nobody left in the theatre.

The moment it was over, Dorian ran to the dressing room, and saw Sibyl with a smile on her face, and a fire in her eyes. When she saw him, she had an expression of intense joy.

“I acted so badly tonight!” she said.

“Yes, it was horrible. You have no idea how much I suffered. Are you ill?”

“I thought you would understand. You understand now, don’t you?”

“Understand what?” he asked angrily.

“Why I acted so badly. Why I will never act well again.”

She was completely changed by the joy and happiness.

“Before I met you, acting was the only real thing in my life. I only knew the shadows of the stage and I thought they were real. And then you came, my beautiful love. You freed me from my prison by teaching me what is real. The words I spoke tonight were not real; they were not my words. I could never act at being in love, because now I know what love really is.”

He threw himself down on the sofa and turned his face away.

“You have killed my love,” he whispered angrily. “You used to move my imagination. Now you don’t even move my curiosity. I loved you for your intellect and genius. You gave shape to poets’ dreams. But now I see you are superficial and stupid. Wow, what an idiot I was to love you! You are nothing to me now. I will never see you again. I will never mention your name.”

She threw herself at his feet and lay like a crushed flower.

“Dorian, Dorian, don’t leave me!” she whispered. “I’m sorry I acted badly.”

3.3 Style transfer

There was a crowd in the dull little theatre that evening. The three men went to their seats and waited for the play to begin.

A quarter of an hour later, Sibyl Vane stepped onto the stage and she was one of the most beautiful girls Lord Henry had ever seen. In the crowd of scruffy actors, Sibyl Vane moved like a creature from a finer world.

But she was strangely without life. She showed no sign of joy when she saw Romeo. The voice was exquisite, but from the point of view of tone it was absolutely false. It was wrongly coloured. It made the passion unreal.

Dorian Gray became pale as he watched her. His lips trembled, and rushing to the back of the box, he leaned up against the wall, hiding his face in his hands. He was confused and worried and his friends didn't have the courage to say anything to him. They were horribly disappointed.

She looked beautiful as she came out onto the stage, but her acting was terrible. She was a complete disaster.

When the second act was over, the audience started to hiss. Lord Henry stood up and put on his coat.

"She is very beautiful, Dorian, but she can't act. Let's go."

"I'm sorry I've ruined your evening," said Dorian Gray sadly. "I will stay and watch the rest of the play."

"No, this is not good for you - to stay here and see bad acting. Come to the club with Basil and me."

"Go away. I want to be alone. My heart is breaking – can't you see this?" cried Dorian.

His two friends left him and the play continued. By the end there was almost nobody left in the theatre.

As soon as it was over, Dorian ran to the dressing room and saw Sibyl with a look of triumph on her face, with a fire in her eyes. When she saw him, an expression of intense joy came over her.

"I acted so badly tonight!" she said.

"Yes, that was hideous. You have no idea how much this made me suffer. Are you ill?"

"I thought you would understand. You understand now, don't you?"

"Understand what?" he asked angrily.

"Why I acted so monstrously. Why I will never act well again."

She was completely changed by joy and happiness.

"Before I met you, acting was the only real thing in my life. I only knew the shadows of the stage and I thought this was real. But then you came, my beautiful love. You taught me what was real and freed me from my prison. Tonight, the words I spoke were not real, they were not my words. I could never act at being in love, because now I know what love really is."

He threw himself down on the sofa and turned his face away.

"You have killed my love," he whispered angrily. " You have spoiled the romance of my life. You used to move my imagination. Now you don't even move my curiosity. I loved you because you had genius and intellect. You gave shape to the dreams of poets. But now I see you are superficial and stupid. My God, what an idiot I was to love you! You are nothing to me now. I will never see you again. I will never mention your name."

She threw herself at his feet and lay there like a crushed flower.

"Dorian, Dorian, don't leave me!" she whispered. "I'm sorry I acted badly."

4. The Picture of Dorian Gray — B2

4.1 Baseline

A few moments later, the curtain went up for the third act. The play went on and on. Half of the audience went out, talking and laughing as they left. The last act was played to an almost empty theatre.

As soon as it was over, Dorian rushed round to the back of the stage. The girl was standing there alone, with a look of triumph on her face. Her eyes shone with a beautiful fire. Her lips were smiling over some secret of their own.

When he entered, she looked at him, and an expression of the greatest joy came over her.

"How badly I acted tonight, Dorian!" she cried.

"Horribly!" he answered, looking at her in surprise. "It was dreadful. Are you ill? You have no idea what I suffered."

The girl smiled. "Dorian," she answered sweetly, "you should have understood. But you understand now, don't you?"

"Understand what?" he asked angrily.

"Why I was so bad tonight. Why I shall always be bad. Why I shall never act well again."

He shrugged his shoulders. "You're ill, I suppose. When you're ill, you shouldn't act. My friends were bored. I was bored."

She seemed not to listen to him. She was full of joy.

"Dorian, Dorian," she cried, "before I knew you, acting was the only real thing in my life. It was only in the theatre that I lived. You came—oh, my beautiful love!—and you freed my soul from prison. You taught me what reality is. What have I to do with figures on a stage? They are unreal. When I came on tonight, I couldn't understand how everything had gone out of me. I found that I could do nothing. Suddenly I understood what it meant. I heard their hisses, and I smiled. What

could they know of love such as ours? Take me away, Dorian—take me away with you where we can be quite alone. I hate the stage.”

He threw himself down on the sofa and turned his face away.

“You have killed my love,” he muttered.

She looked at him in surprise and laughed. He made no answer. She came across to him and stroked his hair. She knelt down and pressed his hands to her lips. He pulled them away and shuddered. Then he jumped up and went to the door.

“Yes,” he cried, “you have killed my love. I loved you because you were wonderful, because you had genius. You’ve thrown it all away. My God! How mad I was to love you! You’re nothing to me now.”

She got up from her knees and, with a piteous expression of pain on her face, came across the room to him. She put her hand on his arm and looked into his eyes. He pushed her back.

“Don’t touch me!” he cried.

She gave a low moan and threw herself down at his feet.

“Dorian, Dorian, don’t leave me!” she whispered. “I’m so sorry I didn’t act well. I was thinking of you all the time. But I’ll try. I think I should never have known it if you hadn’t kissed me—if we hadn’t kissed each other. Kiss me again, my love. My brother... No, never mind. He didn’t mean it seriously. But you, oh, can’t you forgive me for tonight?”

She began to weep with great passion, bent double on the floor like a wounded creature. Dorian Gray, with his beautiful eyes, looked down on her, and his lips curled in scorn.

“I’m going,” he said at last in his calm, clear voice. “I don’t wish to be cruel, but I can’t see you again. You’ve disappointed me.”

4.2 Enriched

A few moments later, the curtain went up for the third act. The play went on for a long time. Half of the audience left, talking and laughing as they left. They played the last act to an almost empty theatre.

As soon as it ended, Dorian ran to the back of the stage. The girl stood there alone, with a look of triumph on her face. Her eyes were glowing with fire. Her lips were smiling over a secret of their own.

When he entered, she looked at him and an expression of joy came over her.

“How badly I acted tonight, Dorian!” she cried.

“Horribly!” he answered, looking at her in surprise. “It was dreadful. Are you sick? You have no idea what I suffered.”

The girl smiled.

“Dorian,” she answered sweetly, “you should have understood. But you understand now, don’t you?”

“Understand what?” he asked angrily.

“Why I was so bad tonight. Why I shall always be bad. Why I shall never act well again.”

He shrugged his shoulders.

“You’re ill, I suppose. When you’re ill, you shouldn’t act. My friends were bored. I was bored.”

She seemed not to listen to him. She was filled with joy.

“Dorian, Dorian,” she cried, “before I knew you, acting was the only real thing in my life. It was only in the theatre that I lived. You came—oh, my beautiful love! And you freed my soul from prison. You taught me the meaning of reality. What exactly do I do with figures on a stage? They are so unreal. When I came on tonight, I couldn’t understand how everything had gone out of me. I found that I could do nothing. Suddenly I understood what it meant. I heard their hisses, and I smiled. What could they know of such love? Take me away, Dorian. I want to be alone with you and you alone. I hate the stage.”

He threw himself down on the sofa and turned his face away.

“You have killed my love,” he muttered.

She looked at him and laughed. He gave no answer. She came across to him and stroked his hair. She knelt down and pressed his hands to her lips. He pulled them away and shuddered. He jumped up and went to the door.

“Yes,” he cried, “you have killed my love. I loved you, because you were wonderful and had genius. You’ve thrown it all away. My God! How mad I was to love you! You’re nothing to me now.”

She got up from her knees and, with a piteous expression of pain on her face, came across the room to him. She put her hand on his arm and looked into his eyes. He shoved her back.

“Don’t touch me!” he cried.

She threw herself at his feet after giving a low moan.

“Dorian, Dorian, don’t leave me!” she whispered. “I’m so sorry I didn’t act well. I was thinking of you all the time. But I’ll try. I think I should never have known it if you hadn’t kissed me—if we hadn’t kissed each other. Kiss me again, my love. My brother... No, never mind. He didn’t mean it seriously. But you, oh, can’t you forgive me for tonight?”

She bent double on the floor like a wounded creature, weeping with great passion. Dorian Gray looked down on her, and his lips curled in scorn.

"I'm going," he said at last in his calm, clear voice. "I don't wish to be cruel, but I can't see you again. You've disappointed me."

4.3 Style transfer

'I wish she was ill. But she seems to me to be simply cold and not interested. She's changed completely. Last night she was a great actress. But this was an ordinary, second-rate one. The voice was exquisite, but from the point of view of tone it was absolutely false.'

His lips trembled, and rushing to the back of the box, he leaned up against the wall, hiding his face in his hands.

'Don't talk like that about anyone you love, Dorian,' said Lord Henry. 'Love is a more wonderful thing than art. But do let's go. It's no good for one's morals to see bad acting. Besides, I don't suppose you'll want your wife to continue acting, so if she plays Juliet like a wooden doll, why does that matter? If she knows as little about life as she does about acting, she'll be a charming experience. There are only two kinds of people who are really interesting — those who know absolutely everything, and those who know absolutely nothing. Good heavens, my dear boy, don't look so sad! Come to the club. We'll drink to the beauty of Sibyl. She's beautiful. What more than this can you want?'

'Won't you go away, Henry,' cried the young man, 'I want to be alone. Basil, you must go. Ah! Can't you see that my heart is breaking?'

The hot tears came to his eyes.

'Let's go, Basil,' said Lord Henry with a strangely gentle tone in his voice.

And the two men left together.

A few moments later, the curtain went up for the third act. The play went on and on. Half of the audience went out, talking and laughing as they left. The last act was played to an almost empty theatre.

As soon as it was over, Dorian rushed round to the back of the stage. The girl was standing there alone, with a look of triumph on her face. Her eyes shone with a beautiful fire. Her lips were smiling over some secret of their own.

When he entered, she looked at him, and an expression of the greatest joy came over her.

'How badly I acted tonight, Dorian!' she cried.

'Monstrously!' he answered, looking at her in surprise. 'It was hideous. Are you ill? You have no idea what I suffered.'

The girl smiled.

'Dorian,' she answered sweetly, 'you should have understood. But you understand now, don't you?'

'Understand what?' he asked angrily.

'Why I was so bad tonight. Why I shall always be bad. Why I shall never act well again.'

He shrugged his shoulders.

'You're ill, I suppose. When you're ill, you shouldn't act. My friends were bored. I was bored.'

She seemed not to listen to him. She was full of joy.

'Dorian, Dorian,' she cried, 'before I knew you, acting was the only real thing in my life. It was only in the theatre that I lived. You came — oh, my beautiful love! — and you freed my soul from prison. You coloured reality. What have I to do with figures on a stage? They are unreal. When I came on tonight, I couldn't understand how everything had gone out of me. I found that I could do nothing. Suddenly I understood what it meant. I heard their hisses, and I smiled. What could they know of love such as ours? Take me away, Dorian — take me away with you where we can be quite alone. I hate the stage.'

He threw himself down on the sofa and turned his face away.

'You have killed my love,' he muttered.

She looked at him in surprise and laughed. He made no answer. She came across to him and stroked his hair. She knelt down and pressed his hands to her lips. He pulled them away and shuddered.

Then he jumped up and went to the door.

'Yes,' he cried, 'you have killed my love. You have spoiled the romance of my life. I loved you because you were wonderful, because you had genius. You've thrown it all away. My God! How mad I was to love you! You're nothing to me now.'

She got up from her knees, and with a piteous expression of pain on her face, came across the room to him. She put her hand on his arm, and looked into his eyes. He pushed her back.

'Don't touch me!' he cried.

She gave a low moan and threw herself down at his feet.

'Dorian, Dorian, don't leave me!' she whispered. 'I'm so sorry I didn't act well. I was thinking of you all the time. But I'll try. I think I should never have known it if you hadn't kissed me — if we hadn't kissed each other. Kiss me again, my love. My brother... No, never mind. He didn't mean it seriously. But you, oh, will you not forgive me for tonight?'

She began to weep with great passion, bent double on the floor like a wounded creature. Dorian Gray, with his beautiful eyes, looked down on her, and his lips curled in scorn.

'I'm going,' he said at last in his calm clear voice. 'I don't wish to be cruel, but I shall not see you again. You've disappointed me.'